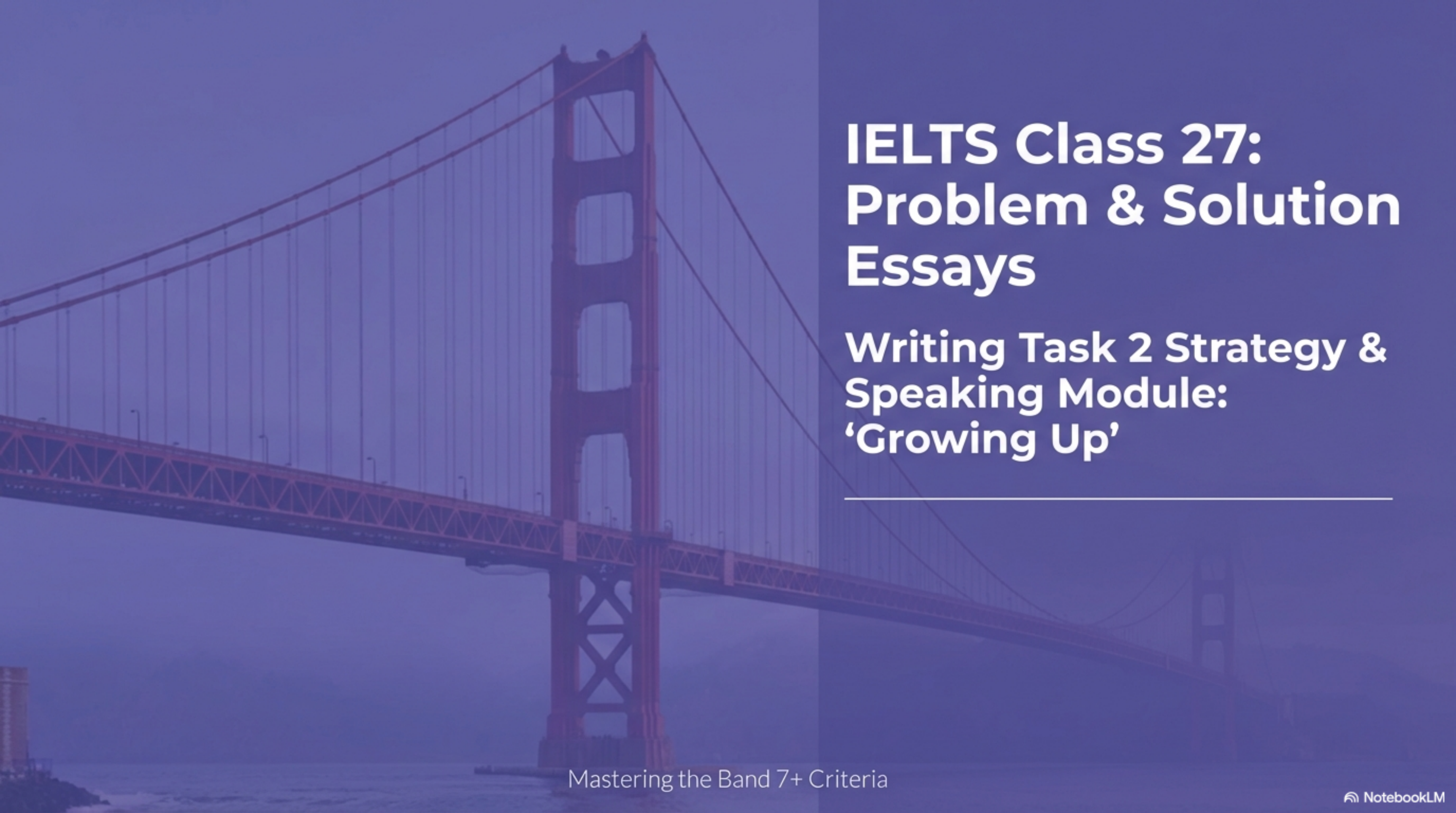


A background image of the Golden Gate Bridge in San Francisco, with a semi-transparent blue overlay. The bridge's iconic red-orange towers and suspension cables are visible against a hazy sky and water.

IELTS Class 27: Problem & Solution Essays

Writing Task 2 Strategy & Speaking Module: 'Growing Up'

Mastering the Band 7+ Criteria

What are 3 major global problems people talk about today?

- Climate change, unemployment, mental health

Can you think of a problem in education today?

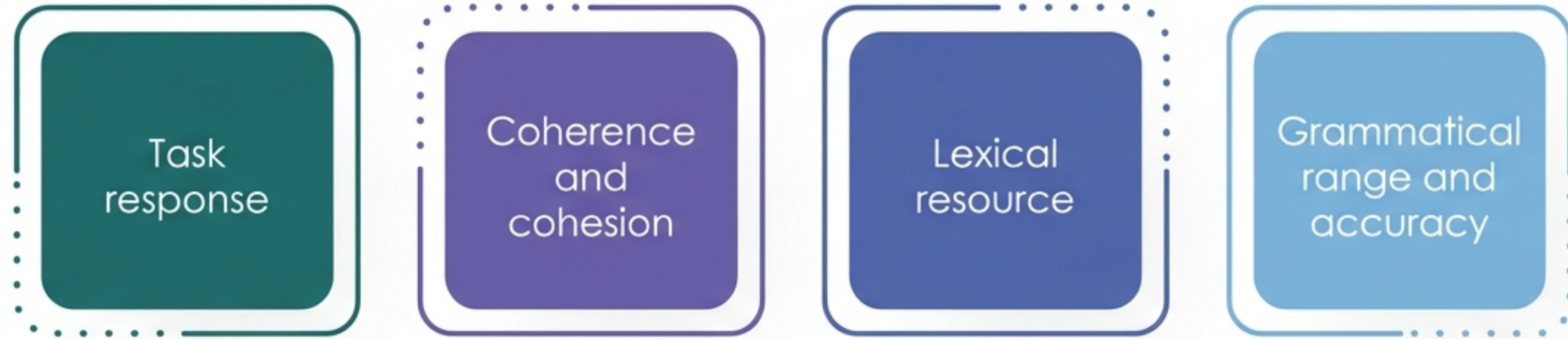
What is a modern problem that didn't exist 50 years ago?



*Caveat:
Think critically
& discuss*



The Rules of the Game: Assessment Criteria



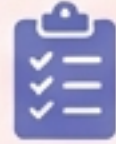
Task response	Coherence and cohesion	Lexical resource	Grammatical range and accuracy	Task 2 score
7	7	7	7	7
6	7	7	7	6.5
6	8	7	7	7

← Caveat

Key Insight: To get a Band 7, you must address ALL parts of the task and present a **clear** position throughout.

Band 7+ Checklist

Task Response



Address all parts of the task.

Write at least 250 words.

Present a clear position throughout.

Avoid overgeneralisation.

Coherence and Cohesion



Logically organise information.

Clear progression.

One central topic per paragraph.

Use cohesive devices appropriately.

Lexical Resource



Use a wide range of vocabulary.

Use less common words with awareness of style and collocation.

Minimize mistakes.

Grammatical Range and Accuracy



Use a wide range of complex structures.

Produce error-free sentences.

3 Steps to Writing an Essay



5 minutes

Step 1. Plan your essay

- Read the task
- Determine the type of task
- Generate ideas
- Structure your essay



30 minutes

Step 2. Write your essay



5 minutes

Step 3. Check your essay

Structuring the Essay: Two Options

Introduction

Option 1 (The Block Method)

Body Paragraph 1: Causes
Slate Grey Lato

Body Paragraph 2: Solutions
Slate Grey Lato

Conclusion
Slate Grey Lato

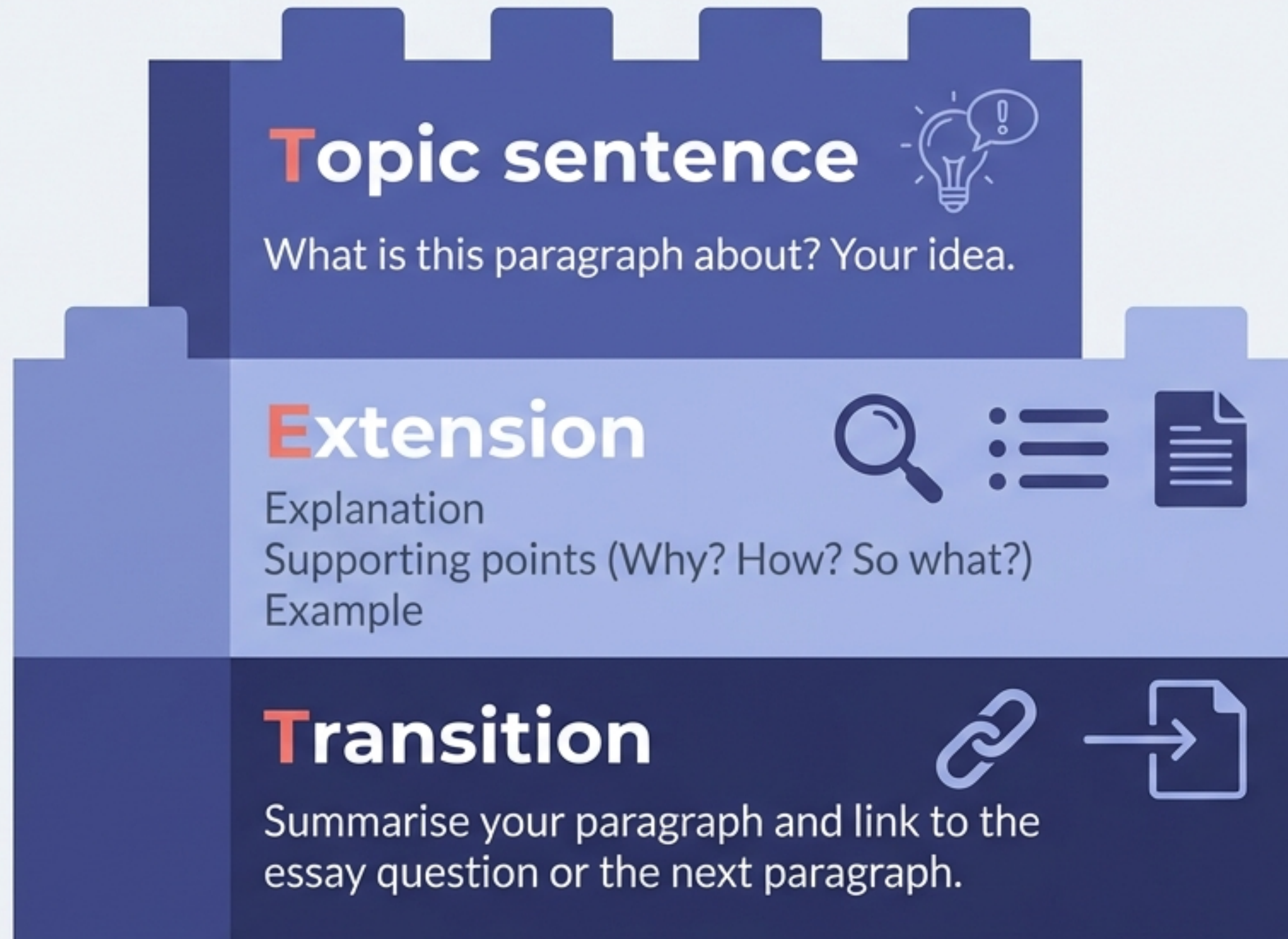
Option 2 (The Chain Method)

Body Paragraph 1: Cause 1 + Solution 1
Slate Grey Lato

Body Paragraph 2: Cause 2 + Solution 2
Slate Grey Lato

Body Paragraph 3: Cause 3 + Solution 3 (optional)
Slate Grey Lato

The TET Formula: Body Paragraph Structure



Case Study 1: Positioning & The Prompt

People in major cities suffer from high levels of air pollution... **What are the main reasons? What can be done?**

Block 1 (Intro)

This essay will discuss the principal reasons for bad air quality... and how this problem can be tackled.

Block 2 (Conclusion)

In conclusion... a significant improvement can be achieved by tackling the largest of them: petrol and diesel cars... the government should increase the cost of owning a car...

✓ *Band 7+ Tip:*
You are allowed to use 'I believe' or 'In my opinion'. You lose marks if you **DO NOT** express your opinion when required.

Case Study 2: Planning (Step 1)

Why do many people not exercise regularly? What solutions can help them exercise more?

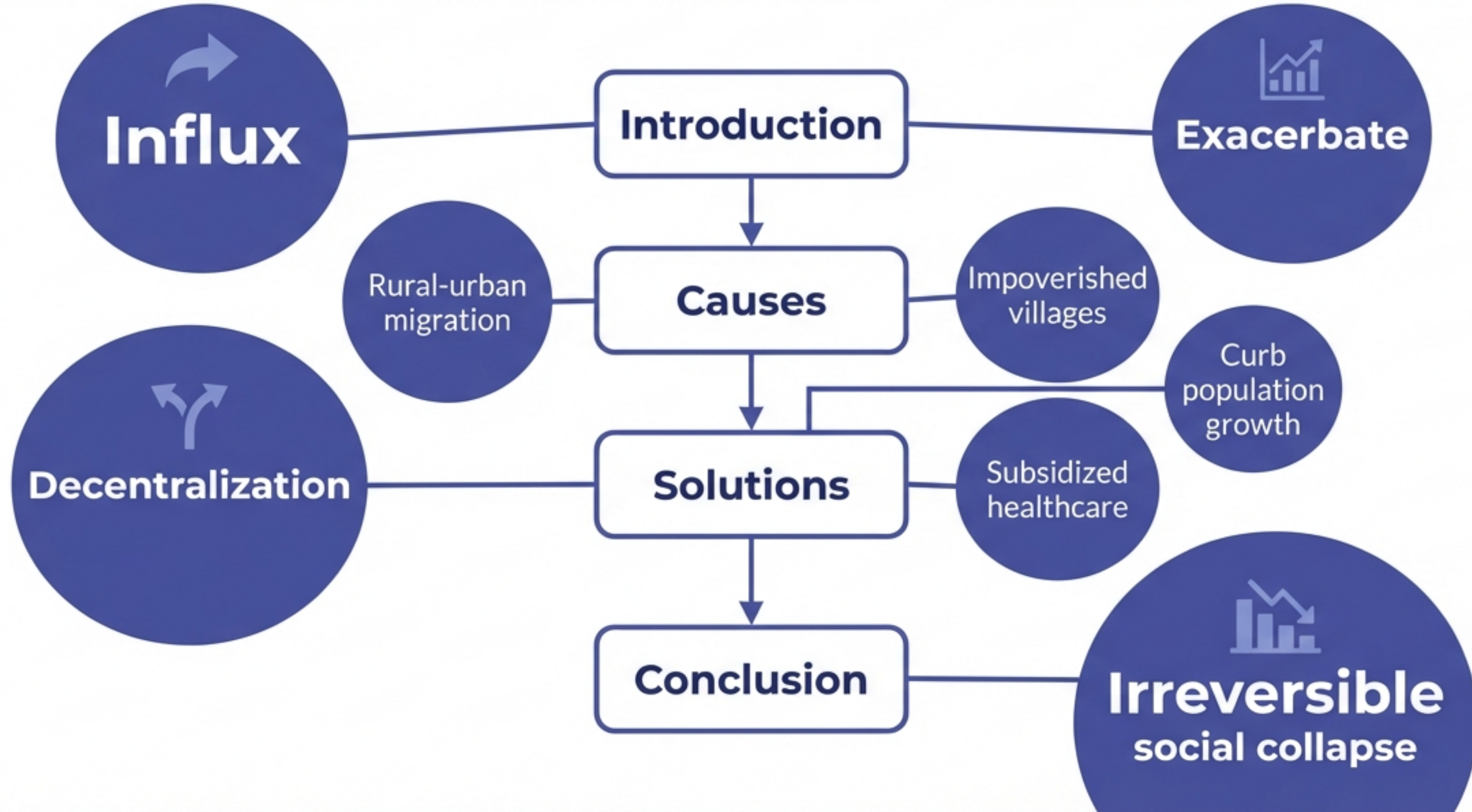
Causes (Ideas)		Solutions
People are short of time	➡	Exercise for short periods (stairs, brisk walk) 
People do not enjoy exercising	➡	Fun activities (sports, dance) 
High cost of gyms	➡	Community centers with affordable prices 

The TET Formula in Action

The reasons why people do not exercise are plentiful; **one of them** *← Topic Sentence*
is a lack of time. *← Extension* **For individuals working long hours, finding time**
to exercise is a challenge. When they eventually have some free
time after work or on weekends, many prefer to spend it socializing
or simply relaxing. A way to keep more active despite a busy
schedule is to take advantage of any type of physical exercise
that is available to them, be it a brisk ten-minute walk or taking
the stairs instead of a lift. **These short periods of activity, which** *← Transition*
have noticeable health benefits, can be easily slotted into
most people's daily routines.

Case Study 3: Lexical Resource (Vocabulary)

Overpopulation in urban centers.



Step 3: The High-5 Check



5 minutes



Typos



Articles (a/an/the)



Subject-verb
agreement



Word repetition



Punctuation

Band 7+



Grammar Myths vs Reality

- There is no list of required structures.
- Even Band 9 essays use simple sentences.
- Avoid overly long, complicated sentences.
- Use grammar to express thoughts clearly.

Speaking Part 1 & 2: Growing Up



Part 1 Questions

How would you describe your personality as a child?

Did you ever throw a tantrum?

Do you think your imagination has changed?

Cue Card

Describe a stage in your life that was important for your personal development.

Vocab Bank

Phase, milestone, maturity, rebellious, cognitive.

Speaking Part 3: Deep Discussion

Topic 1: Child Development

- Do children learn better by copying or doing independently?
- Importance of tolerance from an early age?

Topic 2: Growing Up

- Do adolescents face more pressure today?
- Cultural differences in maturity?

Key Idioms

‘Put their mind at ease’, ‘My mind went blank’

*Use naturally
in context!*

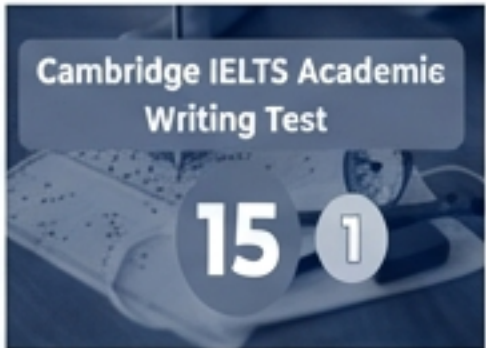
Summary & Resources



Homework / Practice



Cambridge IELTS 13
Academic Writing Test 4
(Task 2)



Cambridge IELTS 15
Academic Writing Test 1
(Task 2)



**Scan for
Samples &
Vocab Lists**

*Instant
access!*